Will heat cost Malta 2.5% of GDP?

A reported projection, tested against the study it cites

THE CLAIM

"GDP impacts from extreme heat exceeding -2.5 per cent by the 2055-2064 period."

Business Now, 18 July 2025, reporting García-León et al. (Nature Communications, 2021)

If there is no further adaptation or mitigation.

A projection, read from the study's Figure 4b; not a forecast.

VERDICT

LARGELY SUPPORTED

The study does show it; approximate and scenario-bound.

SUPPORTED | **LARGELY SUPPORTED** | NOT SUBSTANTIATED | MISLEADING | CONTRADICTED

MAIN RESULTS

−2.8%

Malta's projected loss

About 2.8% of GDP a year in 2055–2064, read from the study's figure (±0.1 points).

4th

Of 29 entries plotted

Only Cyprus, Croatia and Portugal are higher; the Europe-wide figure is about 1.1%.

RCP8.5

High-emissions scenario

No extra adaptation such as air conditioning; the authors expect rising losses even with stringent mitigation.

2021

The study is four years older

Published 4 October 2021; reported as news in July 2025.

Not tabled

No Malta table or range

Malta appears only in a chart; its uncertainty is not given.

FAIR TO SAY

This tests what the study projects, not whether the model is right about 2055–2064. The authors list five gaps, including heat-island effects.

WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT

- ☐ The authors' Malta value and range.
- ☐ Results under lower-emission scenarios.
- ☐ Any newer Malta estimate.
- ☐ A link from the article to the paper.